

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Algebra	Linear equations in two variables	Medium

Question

Line r is defined by the equation $4x - 9y = 3$. Line s is parallel to line r in the xy -plane. What is the slope of line s ?

Answer

- A. $\frac{9}{4}$
- B. $\frac{4}{9}$
- C. -4
- D. -9

Correct Answer: B

Rationale

Choice B is correct. It's given that line s is parallel to line r in the xy -plane. This means that the slope of line r is equal to the slope of line s . Line r is defined by the equation $4x - 9y = 3$. This equation can be written in slope-intercept form $y = mx + b$, where m represents the slope of the line and b represents the y -coordinate of the y -intercept of the line. Subtracting $4x$ from both sides of the equation $4x - 9y = 3$ yields $-9y = -4x + 3$. Dividing both sides of this equation by -9 yields $y = \frac{4}{9}x - \frac{1}{3}$. Therefore, the slope of line r is $\frac{4}{9}$. Since parallel lines have equal slopes, the slope of line s is also $\frac{4}{9}$.

Choice A is incorrect. This is the reciprocal of the slope of line s , not the slope of line s .

Choice C is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice D is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.